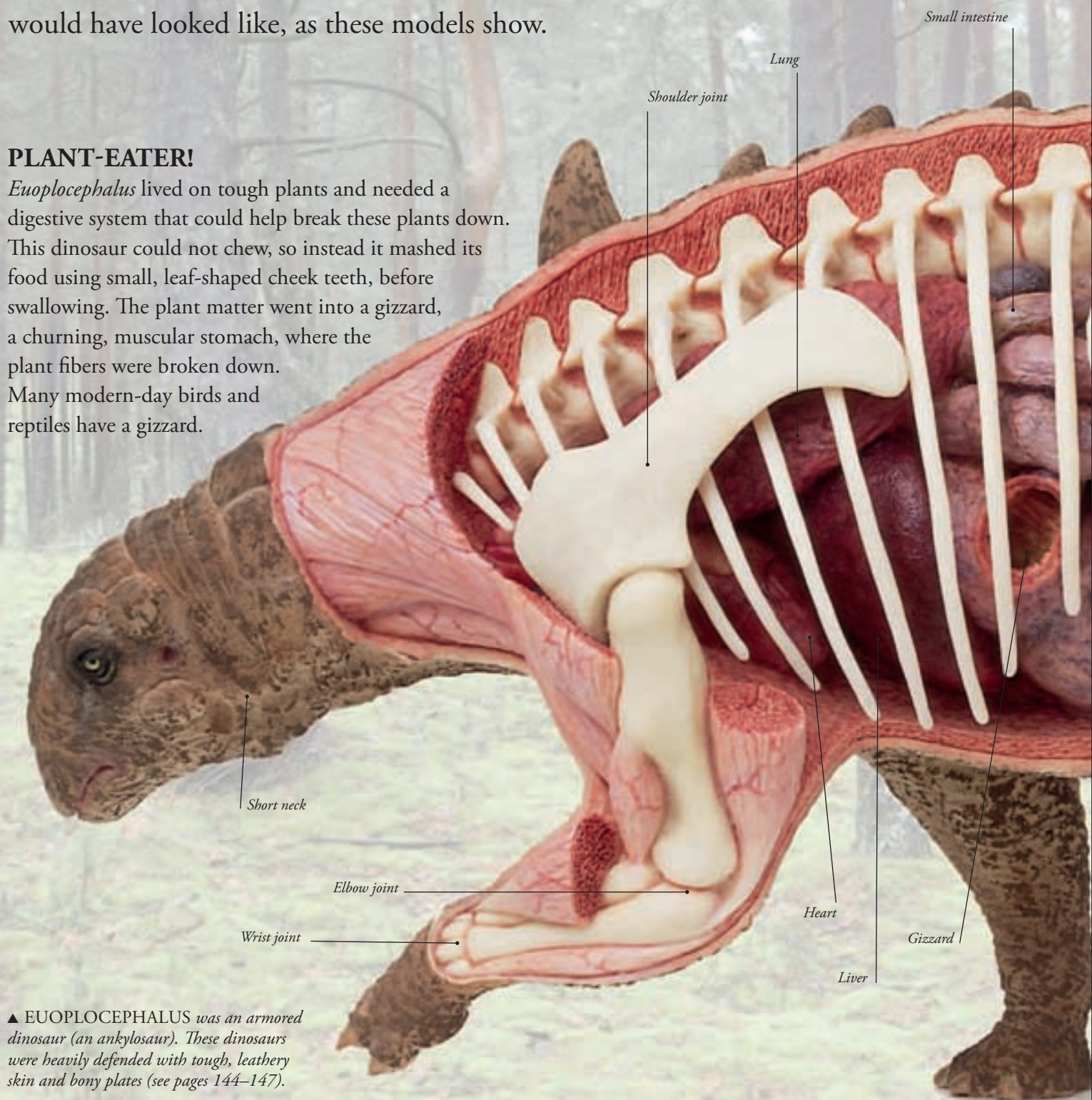


Inside a dinosaur

What was a dinosaur's anatomy (its insides) like? Was there a difference in the digestive systems of meat-eaters and plant-eaters? Remarkably, thanks to fossil evidence, we have an idea of what the insides of various dinosaurs would have looked like, as these models show.

PLANT-EATER!

Euoplocephalus lived on tough plants and needed a digestive system that could help break these plants down. This dinosaur could not chew, so instead it mashed its food using small, leaf-shaped cheek teeth, before swallowing. The plant matter went into a gizzard, a churning, muscular stomach, where the plant fibers were broken down. Many modern-day birds and reptiles have a gizzard.



▲ EUOPLOCEPHALUS was an armored dinosaur (an ankylosaur). These dinosaurs were heavily defended with tough, leathery skin and bony plates (see pages 144–147).